

The Final Over: answers

Year 5 · 14 marks. Accept any sensible answer that is backed up by the text.

1. The scores were level (a tie). (1 mark)

Finding information. A detail to find in the first paragraph.

2. Extremely angry. (1 mark)

Word meaning. Working out a word from its context.

3. She was focused, alert and determined, watching the ball very closely, like a hawk watching its prey. (2 marks)

Language choices. Understanding what a simile suggests, not just spotting it.

4. Winning no longer mattered as much as other people's feelings. Evidence: he looked at the squashed tomatoes and Layla's trembling hands and chose a draw. (2 marks)

Inference. The writer hints at a change in a character but does not explain it, so the child works it out.

5. "He could have thrown his arms in the air and declared himself the winner." (2 marks)

Quoting from the text. Copying the exact sentence that proves a point.

6. He saw that Layla was upset about the tomatoes, so being kind mattered more to him than winning. He looked at her "trembling hands" and the words he wanted "did not come". (2 marks)

Inference. Linking a character's choice to evidence in the text.

7. Any reasoned view supported by the story, for example: yes, because he kept the friendship and helped fix the problem, and Mrs Kowalski was not angry. (2 marks)

Giving a view with evidence. Giving an opinion and supporting it with evidence.

8. One point for the main event (Layla hit the ball into the neighbour's tomatoes in the final over); one for the result (Mitch put kindness ahead of winning, called a draw, and helped fix the garden). (2 marks)

Summarising. A summary keeps the main events and the change in a character.